

# Recruitment and Selection Manual

Policy code: POL-HR-052. Owner: Marcus Feld, Head of Talent Acquisition (cost centre CC-1110).  
Approved by: Adaeze Okafor, Chief People Officer. Effective date: 1 February 2025. Applies to:  
all permanent and fixed-term hiring at Leeds, Rotterdam, Austin and Penang.

## 1. Purpose and scope

1.1 This manual explains how Meridian Instruments recruits people, from the decision to create or backfill a role through to the new starter's first day. Its aim is to help hiring managers make good, fair and lawful hiring decisions quickly, and to give candidates a consistent and respectful experience wherever they apply.

1.2 The manual applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees. It does not apply to agency workers engaged through the temporary labour preferred supplier list, which is managed under POL-FIN-012 Procurement Manual, or to independent contractors, whose engagement requires an employment status assessment.

1.3 Where local employment law sets stricter requirements, local law prevails. Country-specific notes are included where the process differs materially at Rotterdam, Austin or Penang.

1.4 Queries about this manual should be sent to [recruitment@meridian-instruments.example](mailto:recruitment@meridian-instruments.example).  
General HR queries go to [peoplehelp@meridian-instruments.example](mailto:peoplehelp@meridian-instruments.example).

## 2. Principles

2.1 We hire for capability and potential. Decisions are based on the requirements of the role, assessed consistently for every candidate.

2.2 We are committed to equal opportunity. We do not discriminate on the grounds of any protected characteristic under the laws of the countries in which we operate, and we make reasonable adjustments for candidates who need them at any stage.

2.3 We move quickly. Our target time-to-offer is 30 working days from the date an advert closes, and we aim to give every interviewed candidate an outcome within five working days of their final interview.

2.4 We protect candidate data. Candidate information is handled in accordance with POL-CORP-006 Data Protection Policy.

2.5 We are honest with candidates. Adverts, interviews and offer conversations should describe the role, the team and the working arrangements as they really are, including the realities of shift work in Penang or customer travel in sales roles. Overselling a role leads to early leavers, and early leavers are expensive for everyone. Hiring managers should also be open about timelines and let candidates know promptly if the process is delayed.

## 3. Workforce planning and requisition approval

3.1 Headcount is planned annually as part of the budget cycle. Approved roles are held in the headcount plan maintained by Finance and People.

3.2 Every vacancy, whether new or a replacement, must be approved before it is advertised. Hiring managers raise a vacancy using Keel > Team > Requisition to Hire. The requisition records the job title, grade, cost centre, reason for hire, proposed start date, whether the role is in the approved headcount plan and the salary range to be advertised.

3.3 Requisitions for roles within the approved headcount plan are approved by the Head of Department and the Finance business partner. Requisitions for roles outside the plan additionally require approval from the relevant ExCo member and the CFO.

3.4 Every new role must be graded before it is advertised. The Reward team (led by Deepa Nair, Head of Reward) evaluates new roles against the Meridian grade structure within five working days. Salary ranges for each grade are published in the Grade Structure, Salary Ranges and Bonus Targets document.

3.5 Fixed-term roles. Fixed-term contracts are used for genuinely temporary needs, such as covering parental leave or delivering a time-limited project. They must not be used to avoid headcount approval. At Rotterdam, the number and total duration of successive fixed-term contracts is limited by Dutch law, and Talent Acquisition tracks this for each employee. At Penang, fixed-term contracts for production roles are reviewed every six months with a view to conversion to permanent employment where the need continues.

3.6 Replacement roles should be reviewed rather than automatically backfilled. Managers are encouraged to consider whether the work has changed, whether the role could be redesigned, or whether internal movement would be a better solution.

## **4. Attracting candidates**

4.1 Internal candidates come first. All approved vacancies are advertised internally on the Keel careers page for 5 working days before external advertising begins. Internal applicants who meet the essential criteria are guaranteed a first-stage conversation. The internal advert window may be waived only for roles that are confidential or for graduate and apprentice intakes, and only with the agreement of the Head of Talent Acquisition.

4.2 External adverts are placed by the Talent Acquisition team on the Meridian careers website and on job boards appropriate to the role and location. Adverts must include the job title, location and working pattern, a clear summary of the role, essential and desirable criteria, and the salary range. Advertising the salary range is mandatory at all sites.

4.3 Adverts must use inclusive language. Talent Acquisition runs every advert through a language check before publication, and hiring managers should avoid unnecessary requirements such as specific numbers of years of experience.

4.4 Employee referrals are welcomed and are handled under POL-HR-044 Employee Referral Scheme. Referred candidates go through exactly the same selection process as any other candidate.

4.5 Hybrid working patterns should be described accurately in adverts in line with POL-HR-022 Remote and Hybrid Working Policy. Roles in Penang manufacturing and quality should make clear that they are site-based.

## **5. Selection and interviewing**

5.1 Shortlisting is carried out against the essential criteria in the advert. At least two people should review the applications for roles at G6 and above. Reasons for rejecting applicants at shortlisting must be recorded in the applicant tracking module in Keel.

5.2 The interview process is agreed with Talent Acquisition before the advert goes live. A typical process has two stages: a structured first interview and a final stage that may include a technical exercise, a presentation or a site visit. Engineering roles in Halcyon, Tessera and Lumen teams usually include a practical exercise relevant to the product.

5.3 Every interview panel must include at least two interviewers, and at least one member of

the panel must have completed the FS-01 Fair Selection course within the last three years. FS-01 covers structured interviewing, unconscious bias, lawful questions and note-taking. The course is available through Keel > Learning and takes around three hours. Hiring managers who have not completed FS-01 may sit on a panel but may not chair it.

5.4 Interviews are structured. Each candidate for a role is asked the same core questions, and interviewers score answers against an agreed scoring guide. Interviewers must not ask about family plans, health, age, religion, nationality (other than the right to work) or any other protected characteristic.

5.5 Interview notes and scores must be entered in Keel within two working days of the interview. Notes should be factual and relevant, bearing in mind that candidates can request copies of them under data protection law.

5.6 Reasonable adjustments must be offered to all candidates. The invitation to interview asks every candidate whether they need any adjustments, and Talent Acquisition arranges them.

5.7 Assessment exercises must be relevant to the role, proportionate in length and the same for every candidate at the same stage. Take-home exercises should take no more than three hours to complete and candidates must be told how long they are expected to spend. Work produced by candidates during an exercise belongs to the candidate and must not be used by Meridian for any purpose other than assessment.

5.8 Video interviews are acceptable for first-stage interviews at all sites and for final interviews where travel would be disproportionate. Candidates travelling to a final interview at the request of Meridian have reasonable travel costs reimbursed; Talent Acquisition books this travel on the candidate's behalf through the Group travel management company so that the candidate does not have to pay up front.

5.9 Decision meetings. After the final stage, the panel meets (in person or by video) to agree a decision based on the evidence gathered against the scoring guide. The chair records the decision and the reasons in Keel. If the panel cannot agree, the chair refers the decision to the Head of Department. Decisions must not be made on the basis of "cultural fit" without reference to the published values and criteria.

## **6. Working with recruitment agencies**

6.1 Most roles are filled through direct advertising and referrals. Agencies are used where a role is specialist, senior or has proved difficult to fill, and only with the agreement of Talent Acquisition.

6.2 Only agencies on the preferred supplier list may be engaged, and only on Meridian's standard agency terms. The agency fee is capped at 15% of base salary for permanent placements. Hiring managers must not contact agencies directly, sign agency terms or accept speculative CVs; any CV received from an agency that is not on the preferred supplier list, or that has not been engaged for the specific role, is not accepted and no fee is payable. Executive search for G9 and G10 roles is procured separately by Procurement and may be on different terms.

6.3 Agencies must meet the same data protection and equal opportunity standards as Meridian. Talent Acquisition reviews agency performance twice a year.

## **7. Offers**

7.1 Offers are made by Talent Acquisition, not by hiring managers. Hiring managers may tell a candidate informally that they are the preferred candidate once the offer has been approved.

7.2 Offer approval depends on the grade of the role:

**Grade | Offer approvers**

G1–G5 | Head of Department and Talent Partner

G6–G7 | Head of Department and Head of Talent Acquisition

G8–G9 | Chief People Officer and CFO

G10 | CEO and Remuneration Committee

7.3 Offers are normally made between the minimum and the midpoint of the salary range for the grade. When setting the offer, Talent Acquisition considers the candidate's experience against the role requirements and the pay of existing employees in comparable roles, to avoid creating unjustified pay gaps.

7.4 Any offer above the midpoint of the salary range requires the approval of the Chief People Officer, Adaeze Okafor, in addition to the approvers in clause 7.2. The request must explain why a higher salary is justified, for example scarcity of the skill set or a competing offer. Sign-on bonuses are exceptional; any sign-on bonus over £10,000 (or local equivalent at the Group budget rate) must also be approved by the CFO. Sign-on bonuses are repayable in full if the employee leaves within 12 months of starting.

7.5 Offers are conditional on satisfactory pre-employment checks (section 9). Written offers set out the job title, grade, salary, start date, work location, probation period and notice period. Probation arrangements follow POL-HR-011 Probation Policy.

7.6 Verbal offers should be followed by a written offer within two working days. Offer letters are generated from Keel templates and must not be edited outside Keel.

## **8. Relocation**

8.1 Relocation support is available for new hires and internal transfers where the role requires the employee to move home and the new home will be substantially closer to the place of work. It is not available where the move is for personal reasons.

8.2 Relocation must be agreed before the offer is made and recorded in the offer letter. Hiring managers must not promise relocation support to candidates without prior agreement from Talent Acquisition, and the cost is charged to the hiring cost centre.

8.3 The amount of relocation support depends on the type of move. For domestic moves within the same country, Meridian will reimburse eligible relocation costs of up to £8,000. For international moves, Meridian will reimburse eligible costs of up to £20,000. Amounts are converted into local currency at the Group budget rate. Eligible costs include removal of household goods, temporary accommodation for up to eight weeks, travel for the employee and immediate family on the move, and legal fees for buying or renting a home. Costs are claimed through Atlas > Expenses > New Claim using the relocation expense category, with receipts. Relocation support is repayable if the employee leaves Meridian voluntarily: 100% is repayable if they leave within 12 months of their start date, and 50% if they leave within 24 months. The repayment terms are set out in a relocation agreement that the employee signs before any costs are reimbursed.

8.4 Relocation payments may be taxable. In the UK, qualifying relocation expenses up to the statutory limit are tax free; amounts above that are processed through payroll. Local payroll teams will advise on the treatment at other sites.

8.5 Immigration and visa costs for international hires are paid by Meridian and are not counted against the relocation limit. Talent Acquisition manages visa applications with Meridian's appointed immigration advisers.

## **9. Pre-employment checks**

9.1 All offers are conditional on the following standard checks, completed before the start date:

- Right to work in the country of employment. In the UK this must be completed before the first day, using the Home Office online service or a manual document check.
- Two satisfactory references, at least one from the most recent employer.
- Verification of qualifications that are essential for the role.
- Confirmation of any professional registration required for the role.

9.2 Certain roles require enhanced checks in addition to the standard checks. These are Finance roles at G6 and above, and any role with production access to TesseraCloud systems, including TesseraCloud Operations (CC-2210) engineers and relevant IT Security staff. Enhanced checks include a credit check and a criminal records check at the level permitted by local law, and take about 10 working days to complete. Hiring managers should allow for this when agreeing a start date. At Rotterdam, a Certificate of Conduct (VOG) is obtained in place of the criminal records check.

9.3 If a check reveals information that may affect the offer, Talent Acquisition discusses it with the candidate before any decision is taken. Offers are only withdrawn after consultation with the People team and, where necessary, Legal and Compliance.

9.4 Candidates must not start work until all checks are complete, unless the Chief People Officer has approved a conditional start in writing. Right to work checks can never be deferred.

9.5 Candidates who will work on export-controlled technology may also need to be screened by the Trade Compliance team before they are given access to certain technical data.

## **10. Onboarding**

10.1 Onboarding begins when the offer is accepted. The hiring manager and People Operations complete form F-101 New Starter Checklist, which lists the tasks to be done before the start date, on the first day and during the first months.

10.2 Hiring managers are responsible for making sure that equipment and system access are ready on day one. Laptops and accounts are requested through Beacon, and the manager should raise the request as early as possible.

10.3 People Operations creates the new starter's record in Keel, which triggers payroll set-up, benefits enrolment and the issue of the contract of employment. New starters complete their personal details, bank details and emergency contacts in Keel before their first day.

10.4 All new starters must complete mandatory training within their first 30 days, including the Code of Conduct, Data Protection, Anti-Bribery and Information Security modules. The Employee Handbook (HBK-HR-001) is issued with the welcome pack.

10.5 Every new starter is assigned a buddy from outside their immediate team. Managers hold structured check-ins at the points set out in POL-HR-011 Probation Policy.

## **11. Special categories of hire**

11.1 Graduates. Graduate intakes are recruited annually in the autumn for September starts. Graduates rotate through three placements over two years and are hired at G2, moving to G3 on successful completion of the programme.

11.2 Apprentices. Meridian offers engineering and manufacturing apprenticeships in Leeds and technician traineeships in Penang. Apprentices are paid at least the Real Living Wage as published by the Living Wage Foundation (UK) or the equivalent local benchmark, regardless of the lower statutory minimum that may apply.

11.3 Interns. Interns are always paid. Unpaid internships are not permitted at any Meridian site. Internships are normally between 8 and 12 weeks.

11.4 Rehires. Former employees who left in good standing may be rehired. Previous service does not normally count for service-related entitlements unless the gap is less than one month, in which case continuous service is preserved.

11.5 Internal moves. Employees applying for internal roles must tell their current manager before the final interview. Internal moves at the same grade do not require a new offer approval under clause 7.2, but moves involving a promotion do.

## **12. Records, data and monitoring**

12.1 All recruitment records are held in Keel. Recruitment decisions and the reasons for them must be documented so that Meridian can respond to challenges and candidate data requests.

12.2 Data about unsuccessful candidates is kept for 6 months after the vacancy closes, or for 12 months if the candidate consents to being considered for future roles, after which it is deleted. Retention periods for successful candidates' records are set out in POL-CORP-008 Records Retention Schedule.

12.3 Talent Acquisition reports quarterly to the ExCo on time-to-hire, cost per hire, agency usage, offer acceptance rates and the diversity of applicant pools and hires, where data is available and lawful to collect.

12.4 Breaches of this manual, such as engaging an unapproved agency, making an unapproved offer or bypassing pre-employment checks, may be dealt with under POL-HR-040 Disciplinary and Grievance Procedure.

12.5 Candidate experience. Talent Acquisition sends a short anonymous survey to every candidate who reaches interview, whether or not they are successful. Results are shared with hiring managers each quarter, and managers with consistently poor feedback are offered coaching or asked to repeat FS-01.

12.6 Complaints. Candidates who are unhappy with how their application was handled may complain to [recruitment@meridian-instruments.example](mailto:recruitment@meridian-instruments.example). Complaints are acknowledged within three working days and investigated by a member of Talent Acquisition who was not involved in the vacancy.

12.7 This manual is reviewed annually by the Head of Talent Acquisition.

### **Version | Date | Change**

3.0 | 1 February 2025 | Mandatory salary ranges in adverts; FS-01 panel requirement; enhanced checks for TesseraCloud production access